But the trees seemed to know me; they whispered among themselves and **beckoned** me nearer. And looking around I noticed that other smaller trees, wild plants and grasses had sprung up under their protection. Yes, the trees we had planted long ago had multiplied. They were walking again. In one small corner of the world, Grandfather's dream had come true.

Ruskin Bond

Ruskin Bond is an award winning Indian author of more than 500 books, short stories, essays and novels. He writes poetry and books for children as well as adults. He lives with his adopted family in Landour, in Mussoorie, India. He was awarded the Padma Shri in 1999 and Padma Bhushan in 2014.

Discuss and answer.

AYPHC

1. What did Grandmother feel about trees growing in the house?
2. Why did the author leave town?
3. How did Grandfather's dream come true?
4. Describe what the author saw when he went back to the island.

GLOSSARY

rambling	-	wandering
sprout	-	when seeds begin to grow into small plants
spectacular	-	eye-catching
beckoned	-	to signal (someone) with your hand to ask the person to come closer or follow

5QZ4X

READ AND UNDERSTAND

A. Tick the most appropriate option.

1. According to the author the tendril was moving towards grandfather because it
   a. needed light and warmth.
   b. did not like the light and warmth.
   c. wanted to be near Grandfather.
   d. wanted to escape from the winter.
2. Grandmother had wanted the peepul tree cut down because
   a. she did not like trees.
   b. she wanted to grow flowers.
   c. it was an old tree.
   d. it was knocking down the bricks of the outhouse.
3. Grandfather helped grandma out with the gardening because he
   a. liked gardening.
   b. wanted to grow flowers to attract butterflies.
   c. wanted to beautify the garden.
   d. wanted to make the house green.

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